

Running the portal



CF Building Approvals — office admin guide (/admin)

Sign in at the portal address + /admin with the staff passcode · Updated August 2026

THE ADMIN FRONT PAGE, TOP TO BOTTOM

1 Sync health banner

Green = last sync ran inside the hour, all good. **Amber "stale"** = no sync for over an hour — check the incident card. **Red "failed"** = the error is printed in the banner. Below it, any **unmatched Monday clients** are listed: those cards' jobs and messages reach nobody until matched. Fix each with the dropdown ("add as alias to...") or *New client* — one click, done on the next sync.

2 Queue snapshots — Ready to Download, and In for FIR

Two live lists. **Ready to Download**: issued jobs the client hasn't collected yet, oldest first with how long they've sat — a job sitting a week is a job worth a phone call. **In for FIR**: who we're waiting on and since when. Both are read-only; they're the "who do we chase today" view.

3 Portal pages (the on/off switches)

Turn a client section off while you update it — the link vanishes, the page shows "temporarily unavailable", and the matching actions pause. Flip it back when done. No deploy needed; takes effect on next page load.

4 Info sheets & Council forms

Upload a PDF to **supersede a guidance note** (clients get the new version instantly; Revert restores the original), or to host the current **BA1/BA2/BA5/BA13/BA19/BA22** under Resources. When the Building Commission revises a form, replacing it here takes ten seconds.

5 Submission queue (usually empty)

Lodgements go straight onto the board. A lodgement only waits here if Monday couldn't be reached when it was submitted — Accept sends it on. If the queue keeps filling, Monday or its token is the problem.

6 Run sync

Forces the 5-minute cycle to run now — useful when a client's on the phone. The result line shows jobs, files, messages and anything unmatched.

CLIENTS & LOGINS

- ✓ **Add a client** — name as it appears in Monday's Client column (suffixes and brackets are ignored automatically); their email if the board carries it — an email match attaches jobs regardless of spelling; other spellings as aliases.
- ✓ **Issue a login** — username plus an optional **person's name** (their messages then show "Joe, Ventura Homes"). The one-time setup code appears once — pass it on straight away; it expires in 30 days.
- ✓ **"I can't log in"** — click their username to **reset**: a new setup code is issued and their old password keeps working until they use it. Clients can also self-serve with *Forgot password?* — a code goes to the email we hold.
- ✓ **Check folders** — per client, confirms the portal can resolve their SharePoint Issued folders.

REPORTS AND THE ACTIVITY LOG

- ✓ **Reports** — issued counts, the *actual* median turnaround in business days against the 3–4 we publish, and busiest clients. If the median creeps above the published figure, either the process or the promise needs adjusting — the page flags it.
- ✓ **Activity log** — the append-only record: accepts, rejects, logins issued/reset, client matches, certificate downloads (with who). This is what a complaint, insurer or Building Services Board query asks for — it fills itself.

CORRESPONDENCE RECORDS — THE 7-YEAR FILE

- ✓ **Admin → Records** builds a job's full portal correspondence — every message and file, both directions — as one attachment (zip, with a PDF transcript). The transcript says plainly what it does *not* contain: email and phone traffic outside the portal, and internal notes.
- ✓ **It emails itself.** When a client first downloads their certificate, the office is emailed that job's record automatically (`RECORD_EMAIL` switch) — file it and the 7-year record obligation is met without anyone remembering to. The record page also has a **test send** so you can see exactly what arrives.
- ✓ The email is a snapshot at download time — if correspondence continues afterwards, rebuild from Admin → Records before filing.

THE MESSAGES RULES — WORTH KNOWING COLD

- ✓ An update starting `FIR:` or `CLIENT:` goes to the client — portal thread *and* email. **Anything else stays internal.** Never start an internal note with either prefix.
- ✓ `FIR:` then a **shortcut** writes the whole request for you — `FIR: Soil Class` . Several at once (`FIR: Soil Class, Elevations`) come out as one message with numbered items. The card gets a note back saying what went. **Admin → FIR Library** has all of them, and you can reword any of them.
- ✓ A shortcut with a letter wrong — `Soil Class` — sends *nothing* and puts a "did you mean" note on the card. Same for a shortcut you've switched off, and for a lone word that isn't one. Nothing reaches a client unless a shortcut matched exactly, or you wrote a real sentence.
- ✓ `CLIENT:` never expands. It is always literal.
- ✓ Works on a card in any active status; completed/cancelled cards aren't scanned.
- ✓ When a client replies, the office gets an email — you never need to watch the board for replies.
- ✓ Files you attach to a Monday update do *not* reach the client — put requests in words. (Sending documents to clients is a future feature.)

AMENDMENTS — NEVER ON THE BOARD

- ✓ An amendment **does not open a Monday card**. It emails whoever is in the card's **Certified By** column, with the office copied — or Rebecca when that column is empty. Chris or Rebecca replies "yes" by email, exactly as before.
- ✓ The one new step is Kacie's: watermark and re-issue as usual, then upload the revised certificate on **Admin → Amendments**. With no card there's no SharePoint sync to collect it.
- ✓ The original card gets *one* note. No new item, no status, no invoice.
- ✓ Set the routing first — **Settings → Amendments**, then **Rebuild Now** on the Amendments page. Until both are done a lodged amendment sits there silently and the client thinks it's with us.
- ✓ Off the board, the board can't notice one going quiet — the 5pm report does. An amendment email that isn't yours: say so rather than leaving it.

TEAMS, AND THE PORTAL ADDRESS

Settings → Teams: the 5pm report's items as they happen, into a channel. Off by default; safe to mute. **Settings → Portal address**: the address client emails link to. If the portal ever moves, set it here and every email follows immediately — no redeploy.

SWITCHES THAT LIVE IN VERCEL (NOT /ADMIN)

AUTO_ACCEPT_LODGEMENTS	Default on. Set 0 to make every lodgement wait in the review queue for a human Accept.
DIGEST_ENABLED	Default off. Set 1 to send every builder a Monday-morning summary of their active jobs, with a "with you" section that chases FIRs automatically.
RETENTION_MONTHS	How long downloaded packages stay before the files purge. Currently 3 .
OFFICE_EMAIL	Where client-reply notifications and correspondence records land. Keep it a watched inbox.
RECORD_EMAIL	Default off. Set 1 to email the office each job's correspondence record on first download — the 7-year file that files itself.

Changing a Vercel variable does nothing until the project is **redeployed** — Deployments → ⋮ → Redeploy.

WEEKLY TWO-MINUTE SWEEP

- Sync banner green?
- Unmatched list empty — or matched with one click?
- Submission queue empty?
- Ready-to-Download snapshot: anything sitting more than a week? Ring them.
- Reports: median turnaround still inside the published 3–4 days?
- Any new Monday status labels created this week? Tell Chris so the portal's wording map stays complete.
- Amendments page: anything sitting in Waiting more than a couple of days?
- Any "did you mean" notes on cards this week — someone reaching for a shortcut we don't have? Worth adding it.

The two calendar reminders that matter: the Microsoft Graph client secret (expires ~July 2028 — six weeks' warning is set; an expired secret silently stops files, folders and email) and the Monday API token if its owner's account ever changes.

Coming soon: a send log (every email the portal sent, failures surfaced), a client-side Team screen (clients disable their own departed logins), and an automatic bushfire-prone flag at lodgement.